

The best VPNs in India

To begin with, we have to say that all the VPNs listed here are great services, and any of them should do perfectly fine for most people. The differences are slight, and the way we scored things exaggerated these slight differences to give a final rating. At the same time, note that none of the shortlisted VPNs here qualify for the extremely strict criteria for the best privacy oriented VPN services by [privacytools.io](https://www.privacytools.io). The three services that qualify are ProtonVPN, Mullvad and IVPN. Out of these, the latter two do not even require an email address to sign up, and are the best VPNs when it comes to privacy. These three VPNs are not part of our test because of access and billing difficulties.

The first thing to look for in a VPN is where it is incorporated and where it is based. Even though a VPN may originate in say USA, the headquarters might be located in a country with regulations more geared towards privacy, such as Panama or Virgin Islands. There are intelligence sharing agreements between some countries, forming the Five Eyes, Nine Eyes and Fourteen Eyes alliances. Companies based in countries belonging to these alliances may find themselves having to comply with official and legal requests for consumer data. Many VPN services that are based in one of the Eyes countries take a number of steps to ensure anonymity of their users, including a no logs policy, external audits, and disclosures for transparency, which we will come to in a bit. Additionally, some VPN services operate from countries that are part of the intelligence sharing alliances, but

have strong privacy laws internally, and a good track record for maintaining privacy of individuals, such as PrivateVPN, which is based in Sweden.

For a VPN service, transparency goes a long way in building up user confidence. To this end, most services either offer a warrant canary or a transparency report published at regular intervals. A warrant canary is a commitment from the VPN services to provide their users with information requested by law enforcement agencies. A transparency report con-

and streaming services. The VPN providers put up more and more servers, while the streaming services block an increasing number of them. Additionally, some universities and corporate networks have technologies in place to prevent access from VPNs, which can be worked around through obfuscated servers or stealth servers that cloak the fact that a VPN is being used at all. Depending on the country, VPN used, and the streaming service in question, there are too many variables to make an informed decision on which is the most

PROTOCOLS

	L2TP/IPSec	L2TP/IPSec	OpenVPN	SSTP	IKEv2	Wireguard	Custom
CyberGhost	No	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
ExpressVPN	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	Lightway
IPVanish	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
NordVPN	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	NordLynx
Private Internet Access	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	No
PrivateVPN	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	No	No
PureVPN	No	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	No
StrongVPN	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Surfshark	No	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Shadowsocks
VyprVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Chameleon

tains all the activities of the company including DMCA complaints, court orders, subpoenas, emergency disclosure requests by governments, and even spammers using VPN services to send unsolicited communications.

There is a constant battle going on between streaming services and VPN services, as VPN services are increasingly used to get around regional restrictions. BBC's iPlayer and Amazon Prime both use technology designed to block traffic from VPN services. Netflix blacklists servers, and it is a constant battle between VPN servers

suitable VPN for accessing content not available in the country, before finding out the experience first hand.

Before getting into the comparisons, it is important to understand the various protocols supported. The OpenVPN protocol is the most common, and considered the standard. OpenVPN has two variants, TCP is reliable and UDP is fast. The faster and newer Wireguard protocol is being actively developed, and increasingly adopted by VPN services. Wireguard is oriented towards speed, but offers enhanced security at the same time.